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UAE Central Bank halts move to increase minimum balance

REPORTS CLAIMED SOME BANKS MAY RAISE REQUIREMENT TO DH5,000

ABU DHABI

Gulf News Report

In a major new development, the Central Bank of the UAE yesterday instructed all banks operating in the country to suspend planned increases to the minimum balance requirement for personal accounts, pending a formal review of the policy's impact on consumers.

In a circular obtained by *Emarat Al Youm*, the Central Bank explicitly addressed recent reports indicating that several major banks were preparing to raise the minimum required balance from Dh3,000 to Dh5,000, starting June 1. The move, which would have subjected non-compliant customers to monthly fees of up to Dh105, had already been implemented by at least one leading institution.

Welcome news

"With reference to what has been circulated in the media and social platforms about some banks' intention to raise the minimum balance to Dh5,000, the Central Bank has decided to study the impact of this increase on customers," the circular read. "Accordingly, banks are instructed to suspend the increase and refrain from applying it until further notice."

The decision follows *Emarat Al Youm's* earlier report that several major banks had planned to implement the new Dh5,000 threshold starting June 1, in line with updates to Central Bank regulations. One leading bank had already en-



RIGHT STEP

UAE Central Bank addressed reports indicating that several major banks were preparing to raise the minimum required balance.

Dh105

monthly fees some non-compliant customers would have had to pay

Dh3,000

Current minimum required balance for customers in UAE



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Circular from Central Bank of the UAE

acted the change, with others expected to follow suit in the coming weeks.

The announcement of the potential increase triggered widespread public criticism, with account holders voicing concern over the financial

burden on lower-income residents and small businesses.

Financial burden eases

Under the now-paused policy, customers who failed to maintain a Dh5,000 balance in their current accounts would

have been charged a monthly fee of Dh25, unless they met certain exemption criteria. These included transferring a salary of at least Dh15,000 per month, maintaining an aggregate account balance of Dh20,000 or more, or having an active credit card, overdraft, or loan with the bank.

Customers with monthly salaries below Dh5,000 and no qualifying banking products would have been automatically charged the fee, with some banks reportedly planning to increase the penalty to Dh 100 or more, depending on the account type.

FINANCE

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Eid Al Adha in UAE on June 6

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

The UAE announced that today will mark the first day of Dhu Al Hijja, as the crescent moon was sighted yesterday evening.

Accordingly, Eid Al Adha 2025 will be observed on Friday, June 6, as it always falls on the 10th day of Dhu Al Hijja. And, Arafat Day will be observed on Thursday, June 5. Earlier yesterday, Saudi Arabia and Oman announced that the crescent had been sighted, with today being the first day of Dhu Al Hijja, and Eid Al Adha to be celebrated on June 6 in both countries.

SEE ALSO P2

Online booking must for vehicle inspection in Dubai

Walk-in allowed for Dh100 fee at select centres from June 2

DUBAI

BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

Booking online appointments for vehicle inspections will become mandatory in Dubai from June 2, Dubai's Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) announced yesterday.

RTA said it has activated the Vehicle Inspection Appointment Booking service on the 'RTA Dubai' app and the website. "Effective June 2, 2025, the booking will be mandatory for all vehicle inspections at technical testing centres across the emirate," the authority stated.

A total of 27 technical test-

ing centres across Dubai now require booking for vehicle inspections via the RTA Dubai smart app or website (www.rta.ae). Tasjeel Hatta centre is exempt from the appointment booking requirement.

For customers who visit without a prior appointment, an optional walk-in service will be available at 19 centres, subject to an additional service fee of Dh100, RTA clarified. No walk-in service is available at eight other centres where the technical inspection services are available only through pre-booking appointments.

The centres are Wasel Vehicle Testing: Arabian Centre, Nad Al Hamar; Shamil Centres: Al Adid, Al Muhaisnah, Nad Al Hamar; Al Mumayaz Vehicle Testing Centre, Al Mizhar and Tasjeel Centres: Al Twar and Al Mankhool.

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